Millen Woods School Council
February 12, 2025 Meeting Minutes

Welcome & Introductions: Ashley/Emily

- Meeting called to order at 6:32 PM
- Motion to approve agenda, after deferring math and literacy discussion to next meeting – Kristen
- Motion to approve January 2025 minutes – Kristen

Admin Report: Karen

- Staffing update: Mrs. McGloin on a leave, Mr. Croome filling in 3 days and other EAs other days
- Mme Kirstin Martin new 4/5 FI teacher – from another role in the board, FI experience, kids enjoying it so far
- Basketball intramurals – finals were played today – great sportsmanship – thanks to Mr. Philip and Mrs. Webber who ran them. Next comes gr 6 basketball between local schools
- Junior chess club underway – so much turn out they had to divide up the jr grades
- Skating – begins next week grades 1-6 – amazing parent volunteers helping out and donated equipment
- Primary colouring club with junior helpers
- New lunch helper opportunity – next week – grade 4s will get trained
- Ongoing learning for Kindergarten and Junior Literacy Leads
- Tier 3 Math groups underway with Mr. Fitzsimmons
- Carriage Crossing boundary change – voted in by trustees, still needs to be ratified on Feb 25. So far looks like about 10-11 students, not sure how many JKs, and how many students who might choose to transfer to Millen Woods from private schools or the WCDSB or French Board – Millen will hold a School Visit for Carriage Crossing Families on April 15th which allows time to register before my enrolment count is due
- Pro Grant- $800
- Parking – school day message sent to remind parents to park in the neighbourhood and pay attention to parking signs – bylaw in the area, police called by local residents, tickets handed out. The school has also been in contact with bylaw about a review of the street parking in the area, and also considered whether a kiss and ride lane could be implemented but unfortunately this is not an option with the setup of our parking lot and the need for K students to dropped off
- Carnaval happening on Friday – many activities such as tug-of-war, penguin race (beanbags between legs), colourful sculptures, dog sledding (pulling students on sleds), and a hot chocolate station. Bonhomme Carnaval will make an appearance. School assembly beforehand will teach kids about the tradition of Carnaval. This is similar to the winter play day that has always been held but with a fun theme.
- Karen has requested an update on the RFP for the new playground – I believe that proposals are in and the next step is to have a meeting with those evaluating them

Finance Report: Ashley

- Winter Wonderland pizza sales brought in $186 total ($669 in sales and $483 to purchase), and expenses for the event were $886.47 – The event came in under the allocated budget of $1,200
- $1,438 received for popcorn sales
- Expenses – $56.87 for school day fees and popcorn purchase was $374.40
- $56,096.99 in our account, with $50k allocated to the playground so approximately $6k in reserve

PRO Grant: Ashley

- $800 received for our application – thank you Dan for writing the application
- The board will cover the full cost of the Artshine booth format of $750
- Funds need to be spent before June 16, it will be an evening program, targeted to hold it in April
- Subcommittee to be formed: Ashley, Karen in a consultation capacity for the logistics

Action item: Subcommittee to be formed – Ashley to send an email for committee and night-of volunteers

Snack & Lunch Program Update: Ashley

- Lots of apple donations received
- ESNS healthy options were added this month, the committee can ask parents in the community if they have feedback on the expanded healthy options
- ESNS usually cancels the order for school closures and gives a credit to the parent's account
- The next popcorn order is to be delivered next week. Kids' feedback remains positive.
- Emily raised whether there are concerns with choking for the 4 and 5-year-olds with popcorn

Action item: Karent to send out School Day notice for ESNS snow day policy for lunches. *Following the meeting School Day notice was sent!*

Fundraising Brainstorming: Erin/Rachel

Action item: Erin to send survey content to Ashley and she will start the survey

Dance-a-Thon: Ashley/Emily

- March 5, 2025
- DJ and photo booth have been booked
- Daytime volunteers will be needed, Ashley will put out a call for volunteers to the council and then to the school community. A police check will be needed – message Ashley for a letter to get a discounted rate. Karen will accept any police checks completed during 2024.

Action item: Ashley to send out a call for volunteers
Action item: Karen to work on the schedule with class times
Action item: Ashley to write up a communication to go to families to start getting donations in – mention that donations made before Feb 28, 2025 are eligible to be claimed on 2024 personal tax returns.

Winter Wonderland Feedback:

- Huge thank you to the subcommittee and to the school community for running such a wonderful event
- Feedback on this year's event:
    - Mix up with the date of the event, caused some of the original plans to be rejigged at the last minute
    - Entertainment was geared more towards the younger children, next year maybe we can go to the original plan geared towards older children with the Star Performance performers
    - Kids LOVED the mural – look at getting a larger mural next year

- Families asked if they could order pizza by the slice, next year look at ordering a few extra pizzas and selling slices
- Audio system wasn't loud enough – for next year, the entertainment needs to be able to bring a mic that connects to a Bluetooth speaker or they need to be stationary
- Tea station was very popular, but should have an adult volunteer watching it as kids were getting into it
- Hot chocolate had several spills – encourage reusable cups with a lid for next year
- Hot chocolate quantities – this year we ordered 200 and it was too much, the prior year we ordered 150 and it was not enough. The vendor threw in some extra this year which may have contributed to us having too much.
- Winter wonderland was on a Tuesday – because the kids had pizza for lunch during the day, it was a lot of pizza to have it for dinner orders too

School Photos: Dan

- Edge Imaging and Lifetouch will both offer 10% of proceeds back to the school as well as various perks to the school and staff
- Edge is 100% Canadian-owned, and Lifetouch is US owned
- Lifetouch pricing is lower than Edge
- There seems to be no reason to lock into a multi-year contract
- Edge has a dedicated sales rep for our school and Lifetouch is through a call centre. Mrs Moore is happy with both.
- Do we prioritize supporting Canadian businesses even though prices to families are slightly higher? We like the Canadian aspect now but are concerned about prices - 30% higher
- Edge is our current vendor and will do the class photos this spring.

Action item: Karen to go back to the reps with these questions: Lifetouch – do they do digital-only packages, and what do they charge for that? Edge – can they price match the Lifetouch packages? For both – can we do class composites at the beginning of the year instead of in the spring?

Action item: Karen will send out the answers to the questions once received and then Ashley will do an e-vote.

Spring Fundraiser: Ashley/Emily

- Ice cream sandwiches – once a month 2 weeks away from Menchies – April, May, June
- Preorders will be done on school day and will need a volunteer to purchase ice cream sandwiches, sort them based on classes, and drop them off at the school.
- Ashley will spearhead the fundraiser and will reach out to Daniella to see if she can negotiate a discounted price for us for the purchase of sandwiches.

Action item: School day notification to be sent in March after dance a thon for the preorders.

Movie Night: Ashley/Emily

- Scheduled for Thursday, May 1
- Dan will be tech guru
- Colleen will check if Nutjob and Smallfoot (runner ups from last year) are still on the board platform or whether there is anything new that meets the criteria
- Popcorn will be ordered, there is also the option for family-size bags of chips – that could be done by preorder
- Planning to do preorders of pizzas, order a few extra pizzas and sell slices, sell popcorn

Action item: Add to April agenda to talk about pizza and chips preorders

Year End Event: Ashley/Emily

- scheduled for Wednesday, June 18
- Start thinking of ideas for the event

Adjournment: Ashley/Emily

- Meeting adjourned at 7:58 PM

Next meeting: April 9 at 6:30 in person with virtual link

MILLEN WOODS SCHOOL COUNCIL
ATTENDANCE SHEET FOR February 12, 2025

#	Name	Position	Email	Initial for Attendance
1.	Karen Grant-O'Grady	Principal	karen_grantogrady@wrdsb.ca	online
2.	Ashley Feeney	Co-Chair	ashleylfeeney@gmail.com	online
3.	Emily Lutz	Co-Chair	emilywyss@gmail.com	online
4.	Erin Evans	Co-Secretary	erinnfranklin@gmail.com	online
5.	Steph Honour	Co-Secretary	stephaniemhonour@gmail.com	regrets
6.	Raj Pancha	Treasurer	Rajathepan@hotmail.com	online
7.	Sarah Nickel	Co-Communications Officer	nickelsarahm@gmail.com	online
8.	Rachel Sarchielli	Co-Communications Officer	sarchrachel@gmail.com	regrets
9.	Jake Billo	Technology Officer	jake@billo.ca	online
10.	Colleen Araya	Volunteer Coordinator	colleenmw@hotmail.com	online
11.	Dan Collens	Voting	dan.collens@gmail.com	online
12.	Pradeep Chandran	Voting	pradeep24s@gmail.com	online
13.	Kristen Smith	Voting	kj_martin@hotmail.com	online
14.	Daniella Cross-Henderson	Voting	daniellacross@gmail.com	regrets
15.	Julia Klein	Voting	julia.kleinhb@gmail.com	online
16.	Maryam Elsabagh	Voting	maryam_rashad@hotmail.com	online
17.	Nicolas Mellet	Voting	nicolas.mellet@net.com	
18.	Sandra Ribes	Voting	mrs.s.ribes@gmail.com	online
19.	Sarah Boss	Non-Voting	Slouboss@gmail.com	
20.	Hamed Hashemi	Non-Voting	s.h.hashemi65@gmail.com	
21.	Meaghan McGloin	Non-Voting	meaghan.mcgloin@gmail.com	online
22.	Rebecca Kennedy	Non-Voting	re.mortlock@gmail.com	
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Millen Woods Public School
School Council
Monthly Report 2024/25

	September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June		September	YTD totals	Budget 2023/2024	
Opening Balance School Council Account	26,974.56	28,730.62	29,768.63	30,030.09	30,030.09	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35	30,336.35		
Opening Balance WEFI Account	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64		
Fundraising Activities (Revenue)															
WEFI Donations													0.00	0.00	
ESNS (Lunches - Tuesday, Thursday, 1 Friday a month)	2,673.65												2,673.65	5,500.00	
Mabel's Labels (ongoing)	128.40												128.40	100.00	
TruEarth (ongoing)													0.00	0.00	
Factory Shoes (ongoing)													0.00	300.00	
Meet the Community (Sept)			170.00										170.00	200.00	Food Trucks
Fall Fundraiser (Oct) - Esta Chocolates		468.00	1,034.00										1,502.00	1,000.00	
Winter Wonderland (January)					186.00								186.00	200.00	Pizza Sales
Winter Fundraiser (March)													0.00	5,000.00	Dance-a-thon?
Movie Night (April)													0.00	0.00	
Year-End Social & Spring Fundraiser (June 11)													0.00	500.00	
Popcorn Sales	694.00	978.00	275.00		1438.00								3,385.00	6,400.00	
Ice Cream Sandwich Sales (April, May, June)													0.00	0.00	
HST Rebates													0.00	0.00	
Fundraising Activities total (School Account)	**3,496.05**	**1,446.00**	**1,479.00**	**0.00**	**1,624.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**8,045.05**		
Fundraising Activities total (WEFI)	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**		
Fundraising Total (both accounts)	**$3,496.05**	**$1,446.00**	**$1,479.00**	**$0.00**	**$1,624.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$8,045.05**	**19,200.00**	
Expenses															
General Administration			130.04		56.87								186.91	500.00	
Home & Classroom reading													0.00	1,500.00	
Grade 6 Graduation													0.00	200.00	
Playground bins (13 classes x $75)	$720.93												720.93	500.00	refill in spring 2025
Musical Instruments Reserve													0.00	200.00	piano tuning
Extracurricular Clubs													0.00	0.00	
Playground Maintenance													0.00	0.00	
Donation to another School													0.00	0.00	
Enrichment - School Trips/Transportation	$509.53												509.53	2,500.00	allocated $200/class
Enrichment - School Events or Resources													0.00	5,000.00	
Dance-a-thon													0.00	1,000.00	DJ and photobooth
Area Track Meet Bussing	$509.53												509.53	500.00	
Popcorn Purchase		407.99	407.99		374.40								1,190.38	2,500.00	
Student Subsides													0.00	100.00	
Athletics Requests													0.00	500.00	carry year over year
Grounds Maintenance (plants, mulch, garden supplies)													0.00	750.00	
Winter Wonderland					886.47								886.47	1,200.00	
Playground Improvement													0.00	1,500.00	carry year over year ... Gaga Ball Pit $3000
Fall Fundraiser (Oct) - Esta Chocolates Purchase			679.51										679.51	0.00	
Expenses total	**1,739.99**	**407.99**	**1,217.54**	**0.00**	**1,317.74**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**4,683.26**	**18,450.00**	
Ending Balance School Council Account	**28,730.62**	**29,768.63**	**30,030.09**	**30,030.09**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**	**30,336.35**		
Ending Balance WEFI Account	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**		
Total Balance	**$54,491.26**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,790.73**	**$55,790.73**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**$56,096.99**	**750.00**	